

Bad Street Brawler's Power Glove Programs

POWERGLOVE VISION / PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Bad Street Brawler does more than map its own controls. Its cartridge contains nine additional programs, labelled A through I, which it can transmit to the Power Glove. The player loads a program, turns off the NES, changes cartridges within roughly 30 seconds, and then uses the retained mapping in another game.

These are configuration programs for the glove's resident gesture interpreter, not replacement firmware. Each program combines tests for hand position, depth, wrist angle, and finger flex, then emits ordinary NES controller inputs. Consequently, the target game does not need to know that a glove is present.

Program catalogue

Program	Intended use	Gesture behaviour
A	Pinball	Index operates the right flipper/A; thumb operates the left flipper/Up; six-o'clock wrist position tilts/B; pulling back toggles a combined-flipper mode.
B	Joust	Left/right hand movement steers; thumb turns the rider; index or middle finger flaps, using pulsed input.
C	Gyruss	Wrist angles rotate clockwise/counter-clockwise; keeping the index straight fires continuously; pulling the hand back fires a bomb.
D	Deliberately reversed controls	Left becomes Right, right becomes Left, up becomes Down, and down becomes Up; thumb and index supply A/B.
E	Defender II and similar shooters	Hand position moves the ship; thumb fires; six-o'clock wrist position triggers the smart bomb; ring-finger flex produces rapid left/right movement.
F	Sesame Street 1-2-3	A closed/grabbing hand means No; moving an open hand means Yes.
G	Gun.Smoke	X/Y/Z-style hand movement walks; index fires; wrist angles select firing direction; thumb-plus-ring flex suppresses action for menus.
H	Training/general play	Conventional directional movement with pulsed thumb/index buttons, plus an audible indication when the hand is centred.
I	Knight Rider and driving games	Pushing forward enables turbo; index is throttle; lowering the hand brakes; thumb fires; wrist angles steer.

The descriptions above follow the original Power Glove manual. PowerGlove Vision implements practical camera-based equivalents that emit ordinary NES controls. Their thresholds can be tuned without changing an emulator or ROM.

Implication for PowerGlove Vision

The UNO Q contains Programs A-I itself. RetroPie's launch hook identifies the actual ROM basename and requests the configured program over an authenticated control channel. This intentionally removes the original requirement to run Bad Street Brawler and swap cartridges within thirty seconds.

An eventual native Power Glove controller in Libretro Nestopia would still be valuable for glove-aware software such as Super Glove Ball and Bad Street Brawler's glove-only zap. It is no longer a prerequisite for using Programs A-I with conventional NES games.